■ THE DAILY GOODS STORY SCOUT - Tuesday, July 14, 2026

TODAY'S RUNDOWN SLOTS

THE LIST (2 stories)

■■ *Judge torches $13M drug case over 'egregious' rights violations*

The Angle: *A Windsor judge just threw out major drug smuggling charges—and a potential life sentence—because police violated the trucker's Charter rights so badly the judge called it egregious. It's a stark reminder that even serious cases can collapse when law enforcement cuts corners on due process.*

- A **Windsor judge** dismissed **$13 million** in drug smuggling charges and a **potential life sentence** against a cross-border truck driver
- The judge ruled police committed **'egregious' Charter rights violations** during the investigation
- The case involved a **cross-border truck driver** facing drug smuggling charges

The Justice Question

- Should major drug cases be thrown out even when police mess up the process, or does that let guilty people walk free?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/windsor/drug-smuggling-charges-stayed-charter-rights-violated-9.7261646?cmp=rss

■ *Europe's population about to hit a ceiling, then starts shrinking*

The Angle: *The EU is about to reach its all-time population high in 2029, then faces decades of decline—a demographic shift that will reshape everything from pensions to labor markets to immigration policy across the continent.*

- EU population currently sits at **450.6 million people**
- Researchers project a peak of **453.3 million in 2029**
- After 2029, the EU faces **long-term population decline**

The Demographic Reckoning

- If Europe's about to lose population for decades, what does that actually mean for jobs, taxes, and immigration—and could it happen here too?

torontosun.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://torontosun.com/news/world/eu-population-to-peak-in-2029-before-long-term-decline

TRENDING TODAY

■ *Study: People Actually Prefer AI Audiobooks Over Real Narrators*

The Angle: *A new study is challenging the conventional wisdom that listeners want human voices—turns out AI-narrated audiobooks are scoring higher favorability marks, even as the industry battles over whether AI should be doing this work at all.*

- **Edison Research and SSRS** commissioned a study for **Spoken**, an AI audiobook company
- **Multi-voice AI productions** achieved **higher favorability ratings than human-narrated** counterparts
- The finding comes despite backlash over **AI Michael Caine** narrating Homer's **'Odyssey'**

The Hot Take

- Would you actually switch to AI if the voice quality matched—or does knowing it's a robot ruin the whole thing?

ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN

- **Step 1: The Blind Taste Test Setup** - Quick intro (30 seconds) -> Host A reads a book passage in their own voice; Host B reads the same passage using an AI voice generator live on air (or play a pre-recorded clip). Don't tell listeners which is which yet.
- **Step 2: The Reveal & Reaction** - Immediate response (1 minute) -> Ask co-host and listeners: which one sounded better, more engaging, easier to follow? Then reveal which was AI. Did knowing change their opinion?
- **Step 3: The Bigger Question** - Phone/social pivot (2-3 minutes) -> Open lines: would you actually *use* AI audiobooks if they were cheaper or faster? Or is there something about 'a real person read this to me' that matters, even if AI sounds just as good?

variety.com (Tier 2) | Score: 82/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/digital/news/spoken-ai-audiobooks-preferencenew-edison-research-study-1236810295/

LIFESTYLE CHAT

■ *Ontario dentist resigns; 884 patients urged to get tested*

The Angle: *A Brantford dentist quietly resigned in July, and now public health is urging over 800 former patients to get screened for HIV and hepatitis. The timing of the notice and the reasons behind the resignation are raising questions about what actually happened in that office.*

- **884 patients** of **Dr. George Chan Dentistry** in **Brantford, Ontario** received letters from **Grand Erie Public Health** recommending screening
- The dentist **resigned in July** according to the dental college's records
- Patients are being advised to get tested for **hepatitis B, hepatitis C, and HIV**
- The details around why the testing recommendation was issued remain unclear from the public health notice

The Caller Question

- If you've been to a dentist in years and suddenly get a letter like this, what's the first thing you do—panic, call a lawyer, or stay calm?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/kitchener-waterloo/brantford-dentistry-clinic-hepatitis-hiv-testing-reminder-9.7268309?cmp=rss

Backup options:

■ *McConnell out of hospital, says he's got unfinished business ahead*

The Angle: *Senator Mitch McConnell, 84, breaks his silence after weeks in the hospital following a fall in June. His health status has major implications for Senate power dynamics and his own political future heading into the midterm stretch.*

- **Sen. Mitch McConnell**, **84**, was hospitalized for several weeks after **suffering a fall in June**
- McConnell provided his update on **Sunday**, saying he is now **out of the hospital**
- The Kentucky Republican stated he has **'unfinished business to complete'** — signaling he intends to remain politically active

The Recovery Question

- Should voters and his own party be reassured by McConnell's comeback, or does an 84-year-old hospitalization raise real questions about whether he can keep leading?

WLWT Cincinnati (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 73/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 16 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.wlwt.com/article/sen-mitch-mcconnell-gives-update-on-health/71910759

■ *Gaza doctor held 18 months, family fears for his life*

The Angle: *A prominent Gaza hospital chief has been detained without charges by Israeli authorities for over a year and a half, and his family is now publicly warning that his health is in critical decline. This is raising fresh questions about detention practices and prisoner welfare in the region.*

- **Dr. Hussam Abu Safiya**, a hospital chief in Gaza, has been **detained without charge for more than 18 months** by Israeli authorities
- His family and human rights organizations say his **health is deteriorating** and report **alleged abuse** during detention
- The family has expressed fear that his condition could be **life-threatening**

The Broader Question

- When someone's held without charges for this long, what oversight exists to protect their basic health and safety—and who's accountable if things go wrong?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 54/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 11 quality - 10 penalty (Depressing/negative tone)) -> STRONG

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/world/hussam-abu-safiya-gaza-hospital-doctor-detained-israel-9.7267854?cmp=rss

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CLOSER: THE KICKER/GOODBYES

(no candidate scored high enough today)

FLEX (cap check: THE GREAT DEBATE 0/3 this month; TECH TALK 2/2 this month; Advice/Relationship Cluster 4/3 this month)

(no flex-slot candidates cleared the cap/score bar today)

ADDITIONAL CANDIDATES (no specific segment match, but scored well on source/quality - producer's call on where these fit)

■ *China Box Office: ‘Kung Fu Soccer’ Scores Massive $73.6 Million Opening - Variety*

The Angle: *China Box Office: ‘Kung Fu Soccer’ Scores Massive $73.6 Million Opening - Variety*

Variety (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/film/box-office/china-box-office-kung-fu-soccer-73-million-opening-1236809349/

■ *‘Love Island USA’ Season 8 Winners Revealed - The Hollywood Reporter*

The Angle: *‘Love Island USA’ Season 8 Winners Revealed - The Hollywood Reporter*

Hollywood Reporter (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: http://www.hollywoodreporter.com/tv/tv-news/love-island-usa-season-8-winners-1236640996/

■ *Ottawa homeowner had 'enhanced' flood coverage, but insurer still denied her claim after Canada Day storm*

The Angle: *Ottawa homeowner had 'enhanced' flood coverage, but insurer still denied her claim after Canada Day storm*

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/ottawa/ottawa-flooding-insurance-grownd water-9.7268234?cmp=rss

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■ *He missed the net in Colombia's World Cup elimination in Vancouver. Now he's facing threats*

The Angle: *He missed the net in Colombia's World Cup elimination in Vancouver. Now he's facing threats*

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/british-columbia/colombian-player-threats-missed-shot-vancouver-9.7269151?cmp=rss

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■ *Amateur astronomer finds 390-million-year-old crater on Google Maps*

The Angle: *A Quebec guy casually scrolling Google Maps stumbled onto something scientists had completely missed — an ancient meteor impact crater that's been sitting in plain sight for millions of years. It's the kind of cool-factor discovery that reminds us the internet can still surprise us.*

- **Joël Lapointe**, an amateur astronomer, spotted what looked like a suspicious pit while browsing **Google Maps in 2024**
- The pit is located in **Quebec's Côte-Nord region**
- Scientists confirmed it's a **390-million-year-old meteor crater** — **never before identified** until this discovery

The Watercooler Moment

- Have you ever accidentally discovered something weird while scrolling online that turned out to be legit? Tell us your story.

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/montreal/meteor-crater-quebec-discovery-390-million-years-old-9.7268583?cmp=rss

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■ *Canadian trips to U.S. inch up despite months-long travel boycott*

The Angle: *Canadian trips to U.S. inch up despite months-long travel boycott*

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/business/canada-us-travel-increase-9.7268692?cmp=rss

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■ *What we know — and don't know — about the deal to open the Gordie Howe bridge*

The Angle: *What we know — and don't know — about the deal to open the Gordie Howe bridge*

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/player/play/9.7268956?cmp=rss

■ *Iran fires missiles at U.S. base in Jordan escalation*

The Angle: *Iran's Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps launched ballistic missiles at an American airbase in Jordan, marking a direct regional escalation tied to U.S. policy pressure. This is part of an expanding cycle of tit-for-tat strikes across the Middle East with real risk of wider conflict.*

- **Iran's Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps** claimed responsibility for targeting a **U.S. airbase in Jordan** with **ballistic missiles** on Tuesday
- The attack comes amid a **U.S. blockade restart** that Iran sees as economic pressure
- The IRGC also **called on Jordanians to dismantle American bases** in the kingdom, signaling intent to push back against U.S. military presence in the region

The Flashpoint

- How much closer do we get to a direct U.S.-Iran conflict before one side backs down—or doesn't?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/world/us-attacks-iran-tehran-blockade-9.7269216?cmp=rss

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■ *Dylan Cease to be first Blue Jays pitcher to start MLB all-star game since 2009*

The Angle: *Dylan Cease to be first Blue Jays pitcher to start MLB all-star game since 2009*

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/sports/baseball/mlb/dylan-cease-american-league-starter-mlb-all-star-game-philadelphia-9.7268709?cmp=rss

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■ *EU wants social media to kill addictive features for kids*

The Angle: *European lawmakers are pushing back hard on how platforms hook young users—demanding apps disable the most addictive design tricks specifically for minors. It's part of a broader regulatory crackdown that could reshape how TikTok, Instagram, and Snapchat operate globally.*

- **EU lawmakers** are calling for platforms to disable addictive features designed to keep children scrolling
- An expert report recommends a **"safety-by-design" approach** requiring apps to protect minors from harms built into the platforms themselves
- This is part of Europe's aggressive regulatory stance on tech—potentially affecting how social platforms operate worldwide

The Reality Check

- Be honest: do you think disabling infinite scroll and autoplay for kids would actually stick, or would parents just hand over their phones anyway?

torontosun.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://torontosun.com/news/world/turn-off-addictive-features-on-social-media-for-children-say-eu-lawmakers

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■ *57 gored or bruised during Spain’s San Fermin bull runs*

The Angle: *57 gored or bruised during Spain’s San Fermin bull runs*

torontosun.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://torontosun.com/news/world/57-gored-or-bruised-during-spains-san-fermin-bull-runs

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■ *Hailey Bieber shares her better butt workout — after declaring Pilates is ‘over’*

The Angle: *Hailey Bieber shares her better butt workout — after declaring Pilates is ‘over’*

nypost.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/07/14/health/hailey-bieber-new-butt-workout-after-declaring-pilates-is-over/

■ *‘Dancing With The Stars: The Next Pro’ Star Briar Nolet Wasn’t Going To Let A Slip During Her Samba Stop Her: “I Had To Lock In And Keep Going”*

The Angle: *‘Dancing With The Stars: The Next Pro’ Star Briar Nolet Wasn’t Going To Let A Slip During Her Samba Stop Her: “I Had To Lock In And Keep Going”*

nypost.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://decider.com/2026/07/14/dancing-with-the-stars-briar-nolet-samba-slip-jake-moreal-eliminated/

FRANCHISE BANK

WHAT THE FRIDAY: 3 banked (+15 each when found)
- "Meta Begins Data Center Invasion of Canada, Which Reminds Me of Some Weird Zuck Trivia" (gizmodo.com, banked 2026-07-09)
- "Lake Tahoe home invaded by creepy squatter as bizarre details emerge" (nypost.com, banked 2026-07-11)
- "Liberty’s Betnijah Laney-Hamilton ejected for throwing teammate’s shoe at opponent in bizarre scene" (nypost.com, banked 2026-07-12)

THROWBACK THURSDAY: 20 banked (+15 each when found)

- "Wes Anderson Was Trapped in Academy Museum Elevator After ‘Bottle Rocket’ Anniversary Event" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-07-08)
- "‘Rent’ West End Revival Reveals Cast Joining Gaten Matarazzo: Travis Ross as Roger, Bella Brown as Mimi and More" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-08)
- "The #Rent musical revival in London's West End has announced its cast:" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-07-08)
- "JENNIE and Rosalía L.O.L. Surprise! O.M.G Dolls: 10th Anniversary Collectibles" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-07-08)
- "Gen Z Leans Hard into Nostalgia to Spur Music and Content Discovery: Study" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-10)
- "Nike Releases New Limited-Edition Air Jordan 7 Retro ‘Miró’ Sneakers: Here’s Where To Buy a Pair Online" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-10)
- "Thousands of ‘Pokémon Go’ Players Descend on Times Square to Defeat Mewtwo - WIRED" (Wired (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-07-10)
- "Jay-Z Brings Out Beyoncé, Blue Ivy Carter, Nas, Alicia Keys and More for ‘Reasonable Doubt’ 30th Anniversary Show at Yankee Stadium" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-11)
- "Karlovy Vary Film Fest Awards Go to ‘Fruit Gathering,’ ‘The Guest,’ ‘Lover, Not a Fighter’ and ‘Incinerator’" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-07-11)
- "Hilary Duff Delights With Equal Parts Nostalgia and Evolution on The Lucky Me Tour: “Joyful, Fun and Extremely Rewarding”" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-07-11)
- "Jay-Z Celebrates ‘The Blueprint’ 25th Anniversary With Eminem, Pharrell Williams and Slick Rick at Yankee Stadium" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-12)
- "Eagle-eyed fans spot haunting detail in ‘RHOA’ Cynthia Bailey’s photo" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-07-12)
- "Jay-Z Celebrates 'The Blueprint' 25th Anniversary With Eminem, Pharrell Williams and Slick Rick at Yankee Stadium https://t.co/tUvxpPLa9c" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-07-12)
- "Who Can Begrudge Gen Z Nostalgia For an Era Before They Were Born?" (gizmodo.com, banked 2026-07-12)
- "Emerging Directors Need to Be ‘Brave,’ ‘Curious,’ ‘Pushy’ and ‘Fearless,’ Say Industry Leaders Behind Future Frames Program" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-12)
- "‘Cats: The Jellicle Ball’ Ending Broadway Run in August" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-13)
- "Shop star-loved jewelry for less at the Nordstrom Anniversary Sale" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-07-14)
- "The best Nordstrom Anniversary Sale deals on celeb-worthy shoes, from Hoka to Stuart Weitzman" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-07-14)
- "The Nordstrom Anniversary Sale has Longchamp, Coach and more of stars’ favorite handbags up to 50% off" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-07-14)
- "The Nordstrom Anniversary Sale has great deals on A-lister-approved fashion brands, from Reformation to Free People" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-07-14)

Newly banked this run:
- THROWBACK THURSDAY: "Shop star-loved jewelry for less at the Nordstrom Anniversary Sale"
- THROWBACK THURSDAY: "The best Nordstrom Anniversary Sale deals on celeb-worthy shoes, from Hoka to Stuart Weitzman"
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- THROWBACK THURSDAY: "The Nordstrom Anniversary Sale has great deals on A-lister-approved fashion brands, from Reformation to Free People"

SOURCES SKIPPED THIS RUN:

- r/upliftingnews (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/nottheonion (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/technology (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/futurology (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/science (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/canada (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- @WomenBeingAwful (fetch failed)
- @NYPost (fetch failed)
- @EdNewtonRex (fetch failed)
- @CTVNews (fetch failed)

- @Gizmodo (fetch failed)
- @Billboard (fetch failed)
- @Variety (fetch failed)
- 12 story(ies) removed after slotting (content-safety and/or not-significant-enough for THE LIST/TRENDING TODAY; automatically backfilled where possible; see run log)

Scout Report Generated: 2026-07-14 09:05 AM